



---[ 40 YEARS OF PHRACK ]---

---[ Hacking, Zines & Digital Dissent ]---

::: chompie ::: netspooky ::: richinseattle :::

DEFCON 2025

# Who Are We?



chompie



netspooky



richinseattle



# What is Phrack?

Zine founded in 1985

Older than the World Wide Web

Originally covering phone phreaking,  
Phrack later expanded to discuss  
computer security

Influential papers include The Hacker  
Manifesto (7:3), Smashing The Stack  
For Fun And Profit (49:14), The Art Of  
Port Scanning (51:11)

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      [ ]etal/ /hop/
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(314)432-0756
24 Hours A Day, 300/1200 Baud

Presents....

==Phrack Inc.==
Volume One, Issue One, Phile 1 of 8
Introduction...
```

Welcome to the Phrack Inc. Philes. Basically, we are a group of phile writers who have combined our philes and are distributing them in a group. This newsletter-type project is home-based at Metal Shop. If you or your group are interested in writing philes for Phrack Inc. you, your group, your BBS, or any other credits will be included. These philes may include articles on telcom (phreaking/hacking), anarchy (guns and death & destruction) or cracking. Other topics will be allowed also to an certain extent. If you feel you have some material that's original, please call and we'll include it in the next issue possible. Also, you are welcomed to put up these philes on your BBS/AE/Catfur/ Etc. The philes will be regularly available on Metal Shop. If you wish to say in the philes that your BBS will also be sponsoring Phrack Inc., please leave feedback to me, Taran King stating you'd like your BBS in the credits. Later on.

TARAN KING  
2600 CLUB!  
METAL SHOP SYSOP



# Phrack Eras

1985 - Taran King and Knight Lightning

- It all began on the Metal Shop BBS run by Taran King
- Eventually raided in 1989 by US Secret Service for disclosure of E911 documents
- This led to the creation of the EFF
- The Hacker Crackdown - Bruce Sterling
- The paper you all know: "The Conscience of a Hacker" / Hacker Manifesto (The Mentor)





# Phrack Eras

1992 - Erik Bloodaxe

- Legion of Doom, reporting on busts and hacks
- X.25, phreaking, early mobile networks, VAX/VMS

1996 - route

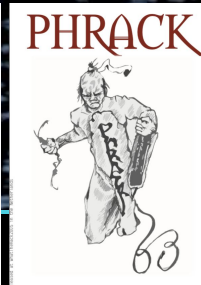
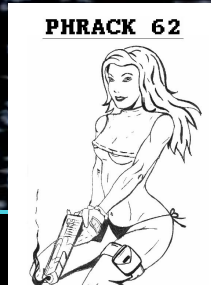
- Smashing the Stack for Fun and Profit
- Fyodor releases Nmap in phrack



# Phrack Eras

## 2001 - phrackstaff

- Gera vs format strings (also Tim Newsham)
  - Ret2libc (nergal improving on Solar Designer's tek
  - Kernel /dev/(k)mem Rootkits - sd & devik
  - Gruq's work on ELF hardening & Living off the Land
  - Vudu malloc (MaXX) & Once upon a free()
- 
- Phrack adopted a systems security research focus
  - Phrack 57 - First physical print at HAL 2001
  - Phrack 62 - Ruxcon (2004, Melbourne, Australia)
  - Phrack 63 - What the Hack (2005, Dutch Hacking Camp)





# Phrack Eras

2005 - The Circle of Lost Hackers (mayhem, tiago, strauss, tbob, and friends)

- OSX Exploitation (nemo)
- SMM Hacking (Core Collapse)
- Malloc Maleficarum - (Phantasmal Phantasmagoria)
- Malloc Des-Maleficarum (blakangl)
- Radare is released (pancake)
- OSX rootkits (ghalen and wowie)



# Phrack Eras

## 2010 - new Phrack Staff

- Argp & huku jemalloc exploitation
- Felinemenace vs ProFTPD
- Blackngel's House of Lore techniques
- BSDaemon's taint analysis
- Elfmaster on kprobes and ELF infection
- APortnoy Flash & Shockwave exploitation
- obj-c exploitation (nemo)
- OSX rootkits (fG!)





# The Handoff

In August 2023, the previous Phrack staff asked tmp.0ut if they would like to run Phrack



thaddeus e. grugq

Hey

Reaching out on behalf of the Phrack editorial team.  
Wondering if I can discuss something with the tmpout team.

Aug 30, 2023, 10:49 AM

Sure thing. What's the best way to chat? We have discord which might be easiest, but can do an email chain if needed

Aug 30, 2023, 12:36 PM

Haha, discord. Kids these days 🙄:P

Yeah, I think we can do discord

Aug 30, 2023, 12:50 PM



tmp.out Volume 1 - April 2021

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# Phrack 71

Last year, we released Phrack 71  
at Defcon

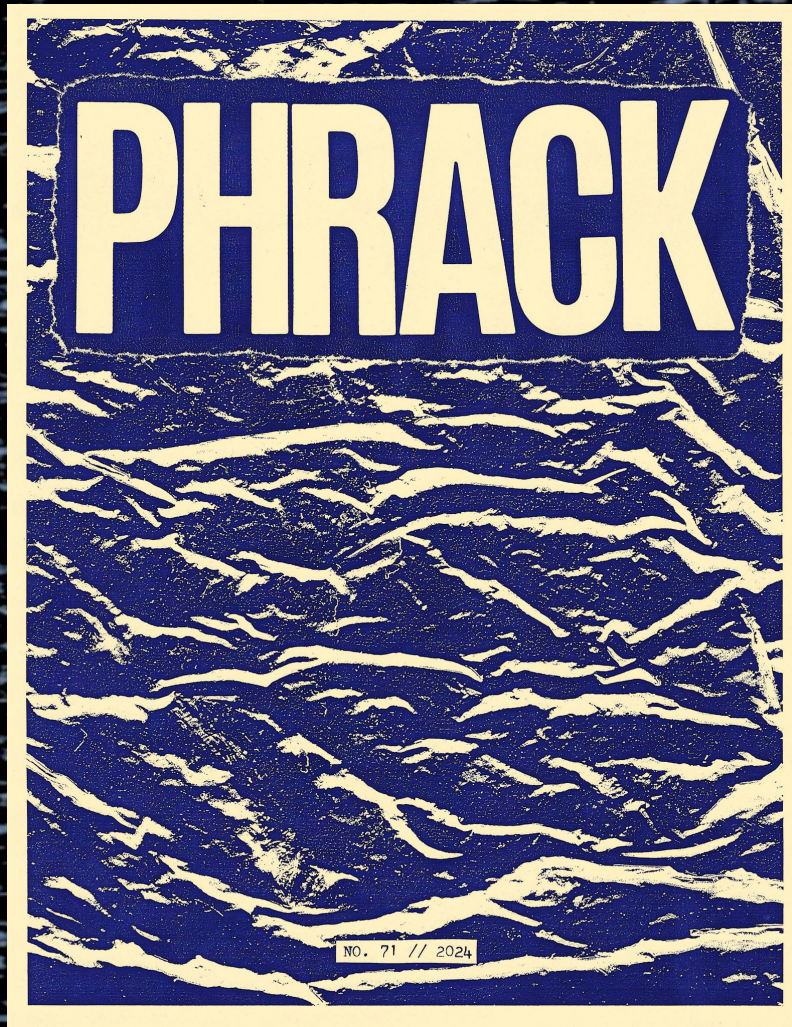
500 copies at Defcon

1000 copies at H2HC

500 copies for NullByte

100 copies for AlligatorCon

Our first release as new staff





# Phrack 72: Behind the Zine

CFP released January 2025

We expanded our staff, editor team, arts team, and the PDF wizards at Paged Out volunteered to help us with the print layout.

This is great, but still needed papers.



# If not you, who? If not now, when?

We hassled our friends, colleagues and strangers alike to submit papers, but we got some common reactions from them.

Elephant in the room: Imposter Syndrome

The second most common reaction: What Is Phrack?

- You ARE the next generation
- We want to hear from you
- We want to keep the hacker spirit alive

"If not you, who? If not now, when?"  
Phineas Phisher

## PHRACK # 71 CALL FOR PAPERS

posted by Phrack Staff



::. You Should Write For Phrack ::.

So why should you write for Phrack?

- You have a project you've been working on that pushes the limits in some way, doing things that haven't been publicly shared before. If you do cutting edge security research, you should write for Phrack.
- You are interested in aspects of security and technology that other people don't seem to care about or understand. If you feel like you need to shed light on a certain topic for all to see, you should write for Phrack.
- You keep seeing the same problems over and over and wish someone would just write a straightforward guide for everyone. If you are the person who can write that for now and future generations, you should write for Phrack.
- You deserve a place to share your finest work without fear. If you don't want something you poured your heart and soul into turned into another metric for shareholders and potential investors or trapped forever inside a corporate VPN, you should write for Phrack.

Worst Case Scenario: You just wrote a cool paper you can share on your own.

Best Case Scenario: Your paper gets published in Phrack. :)





# Phrack 72 Release

We are happy to announce Phrack 72!

16 mainline papers, 8 linoise

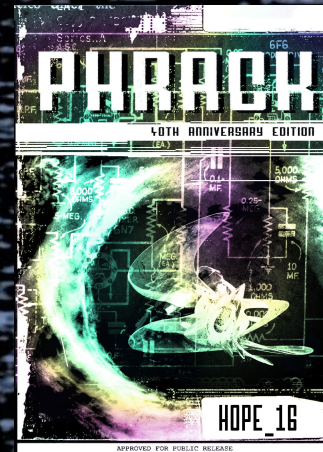
15,000 copies total (all free)

500L of free beer

1200 Phrack mugs

Simultaneous international release

The biggest Phrack...ever!!!



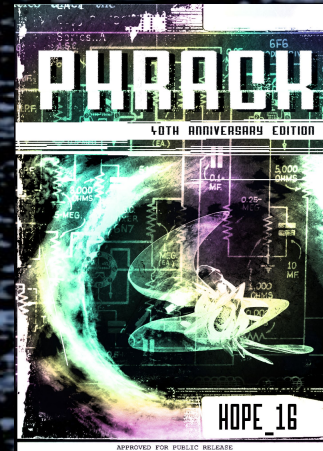


# Phrack 72 Release

This was truly “By The Hackers, For The Hackers”

Many generations of hackers chipped in to make this happen, with articles, art, donations, space, and logistics support

None of this would have been possible without your support





# DEFCON Release

Designed by mar

Huge thank you to DEFCON for  
logistics support and printing

Shout out to cstone & reg desk and  
hattori & Hardware Hacking Village  
for helping make things happen this  
week



# WHY 2025

Designed by bubok arsonian

Available at What Hackers Yearn  
(happening right now)





# HOPE NYC 2025

Designed by digitalis & p0rtL

Available at Hackers On Planet  
Earth in NYC next week!

Shoutout 2600





# Digital and Mail Order

Designed by netspooky

We will share the link to purchase  
copies on our website

Makes a great gift!





# Upcoming Releases

HITCON - Taiwan

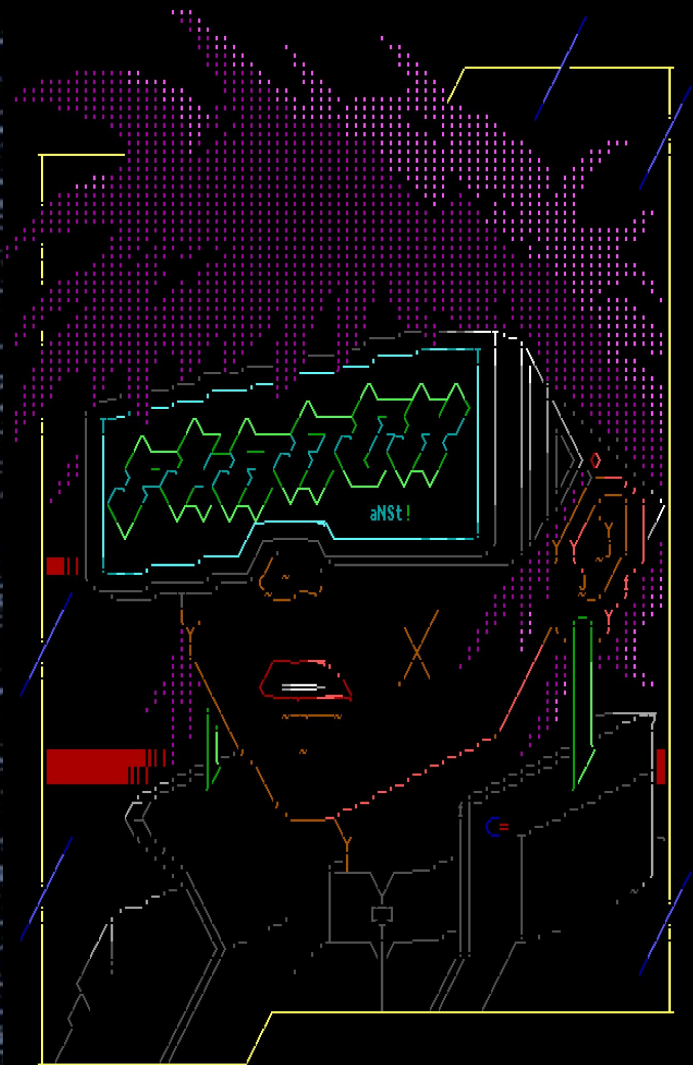
(August 15-16 2025)

DragonJARCON - Medellín, Colombia

(Sep. 10-11 2025)

Alligatorcon in Kraków, Poland

(Sep. 11-13 2025)



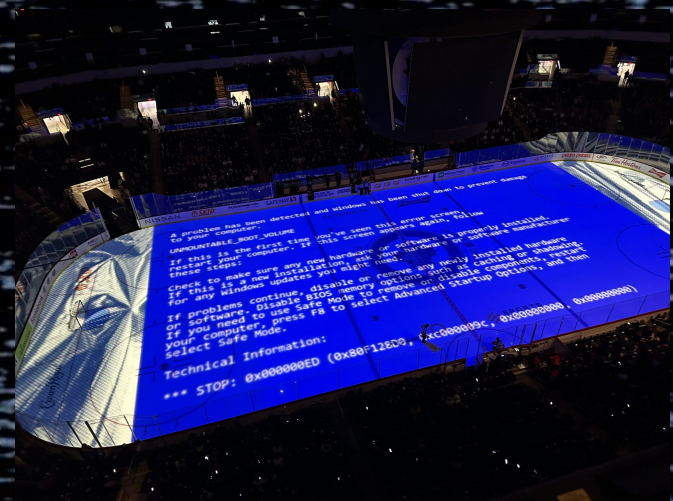
# Phrack 72 CTF

Designed by chompie

Parallel Play: Combine the QR code in the Defcon release with the QR code from the WHY release.

# Two binary exploitation challenges targeting both Linux and Windows

The winner wins a coin and gets their write-up on the Phrack website!





# Phrack Coins

Designed by ackmage

Our token of appreciation  
for authors and others who  
have helped make Phrack what  
it is.



# Get Involved

Papers: [submissions@phrack.org](mailto:submissions@phrack.org)

- We don't bite!!

Rants n' Raves: [loopback@phrack.org](mailto:loopback@phrack.org)

- Send us your feedback about the issue, tell us stories

Arts & Leisure: [arts@phrack.org](mailto:arts@phrack.org)

- We may just feature it in the next issue!

Check our running CFP for paper topics





# Thank You

Thank you to everyone who helped make the physical copies a reality

Thank you to everyone who spread the good word about Phrack

Thanks Defcon for making Phrack's 40th anniversary part of the con

# Phrack Panel

## Discussion by the Panel

- cts (71:17)
- pi3 (67:13)
- r3tr074 (71:10)
- ris (Phrack Staff)
- tiago (63:4)





SMASHING THE CANO FOR FUN AND PROFIT



OKSRO  
A SALIR

"ZALRIE"

